

FEMA National Watch Center

Daily Operations Briefing

Tuesday, September 22, 2026

8:30 a.m. ET



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National Current Operations / Monitoring

New Significant Incidents / Ongoing Operations:

- No new significant incidents / operations

Disaster Declaration Activity:

- No new declaration activity

Hazard Monitoring:

- Excessive Rainfall / Flash Flooding – New Mexico, Central/Southern Appalachians to Mid-Atlantic
- Tropical Activity:
 - Atlantic:
 - Tropical Storm Fay
 - Disturbance 1: Low (30%)
 - Eastern and Central Pacific:
 - Hurricane Polo (CAT-4)
 - Tropical Storm Odalys
 - Disturbance 1: High (90%)
 - Disturbance 2: Medium (60%)
 - Western Pacific: Invest 91W: High

Event Monitoring:

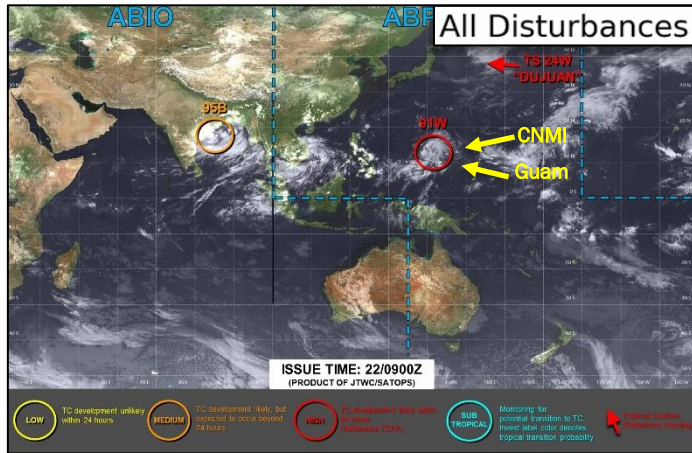
- 81st United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) – New York, NY



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Tropical Outlook

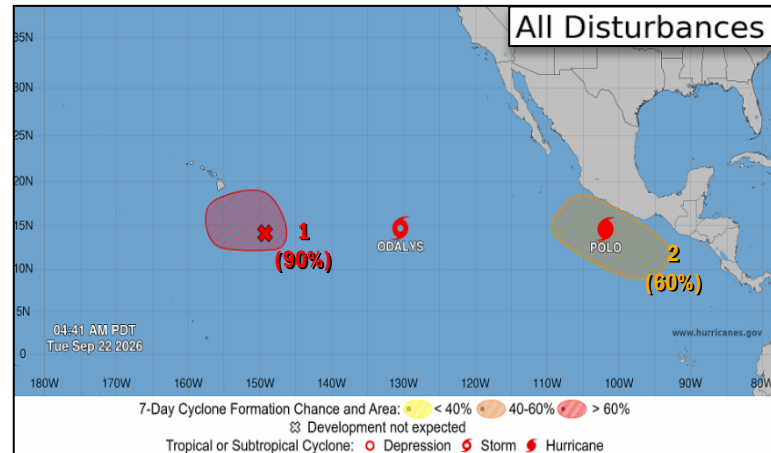
Western Pacific



Disturbance 91W: (JTWC, as of 2:00 a.m. ET)

- Located approximately 199 miles WSW of Guam
- Moving WNW at 7 mph
- Development potential is high, with a tropical depression possible within 24-48 hours as the system tracks NW
- Formation chance – 24-hour: High

Eastern and Central Pacific



Hurricane Polo (CAT-4): (Advisory #7, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- See following slide

Tropical Storm Odalys: (Advisory #9, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- See following slide

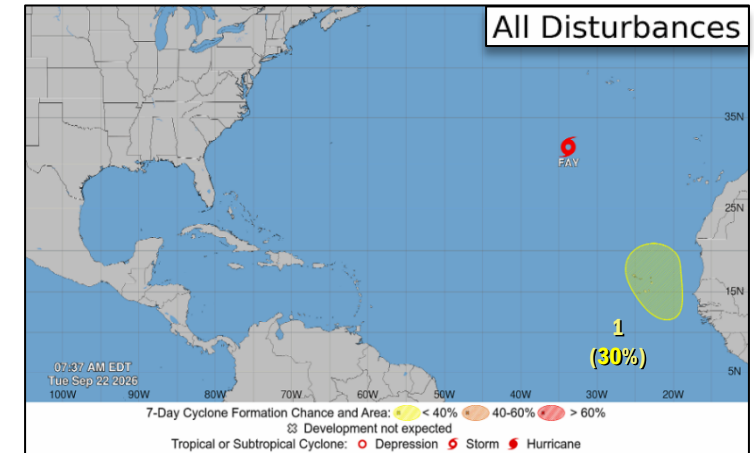
Disturbance 1: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located several hundred miles SE of the Hawaiian Islands
- Environmental conditions are forecast to be conducive for development; tropical depression is likely to form midweek
- Formation chance – 48-hour: High (70%); 7-day: High (90%)

Disturbance 2: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Could form in a few days S of the Gulf of Tehuantepec
- Environmental conditions appear favorable for gradual development and a tropical depression could form late this week or this weekend
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (near 0%); 7-day: Medium (60%)

Atlantic



Tropical Storm Fay: (Advisory #12 as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 570 miles SW of the Azores
- Maximum sustained winds of 40 mph
- Moving SW at 9 mph
- Tropical-storm-force winds extend up to 45 miles from center
- Fay is likely to degenerate into a post-tropical remnant low today

Disturbance 1: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Tropical wave located off western Africa
- Slow development is possible as system moves near Cabo Verde later this week
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (near 0%); 7-day: Low (30%)



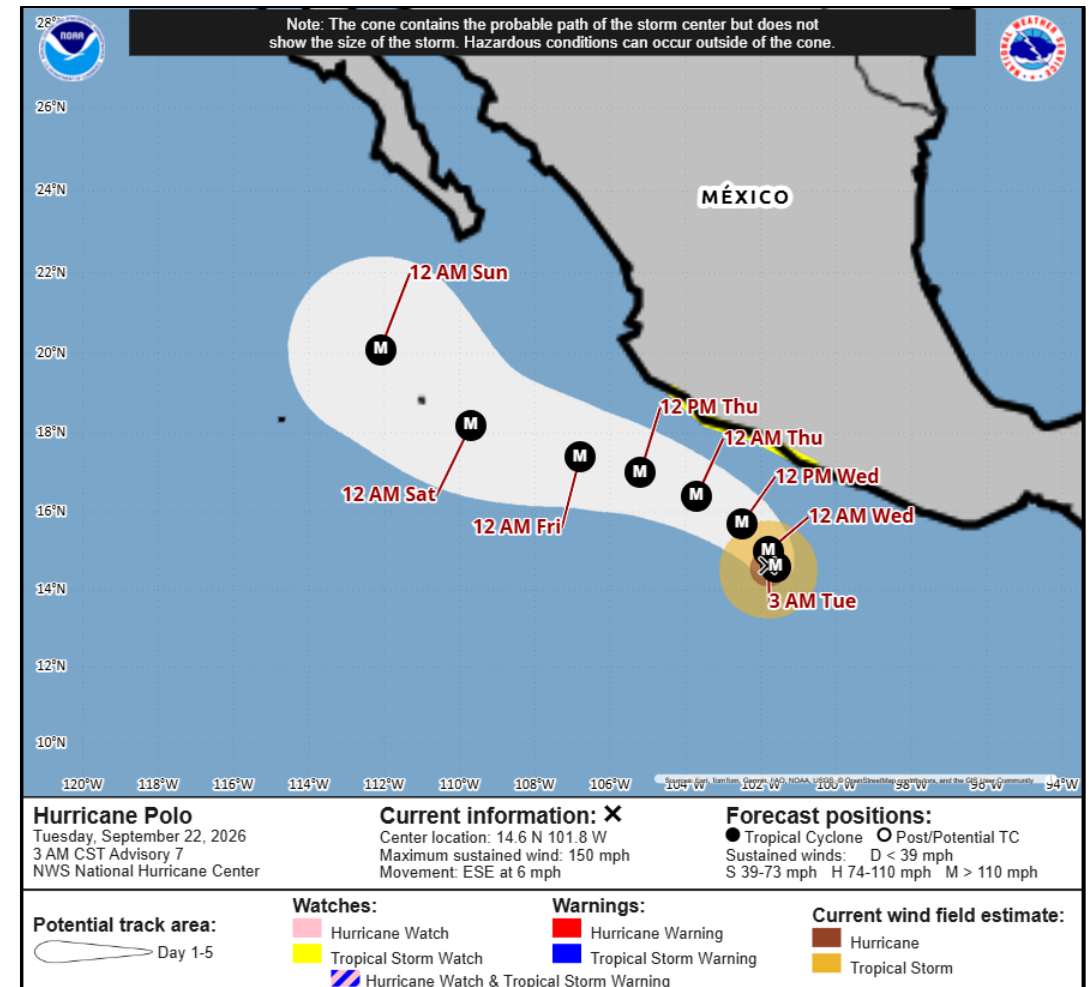
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Hurricane Polo (CAT-4) – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #7, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located **345 miles SSE** of Manzanillo, Mexico
- Moving **ESE** at **6 mph**
- Maximum sustained winds **150 mph**
- **Hurricane-force winds extend up to 35 miles from center**; tropical-storm-force winds extend up to **90 miles from center**
- **Continued rapid intensification is forecast, and Polo could become a Category 5 hurricane later today**



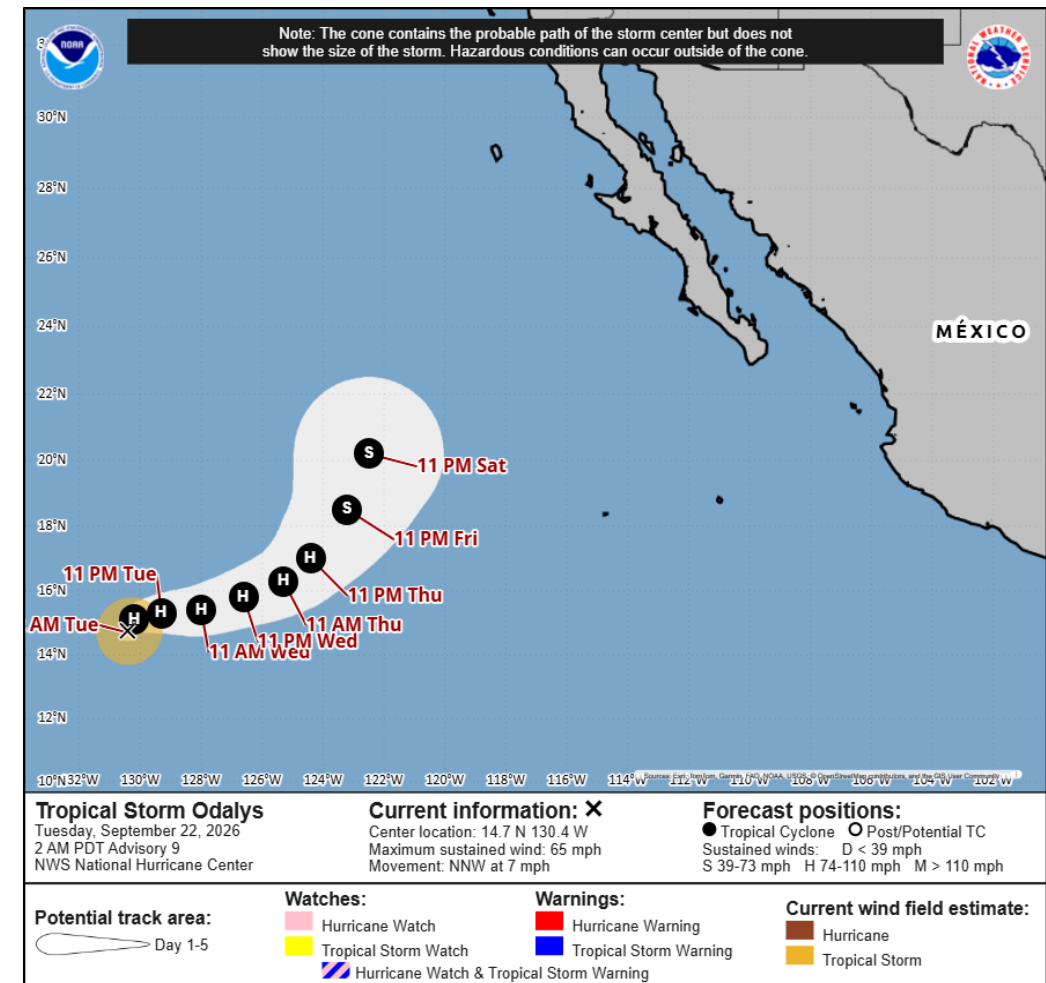
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Tropical Storm Odalys – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #9, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

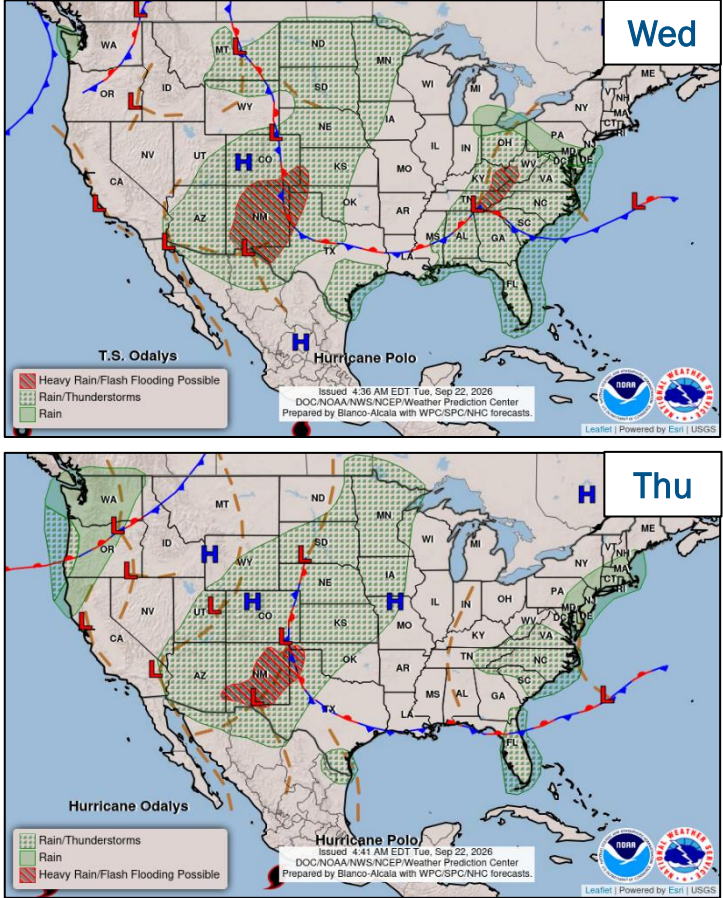
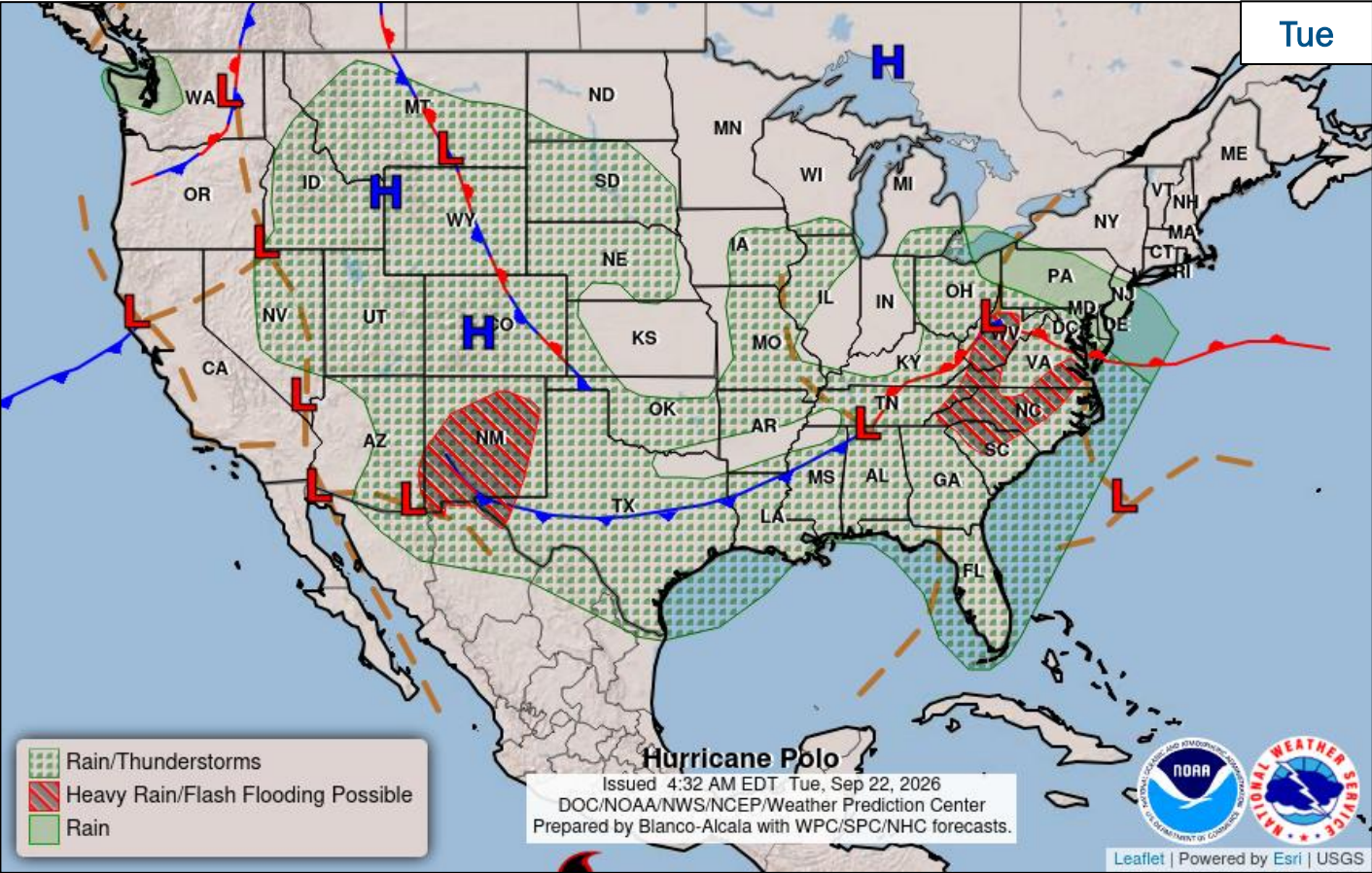
- Located 1,455 miles WSW of the southern tip of Baja California
- Moving NNW at 7 mph
- Maximum sustained winds 65 mph
- Tropical-storm-force winds extend 80 miles from center
- Gradual strengthening expected; forecast to become a hurricane by mid-week



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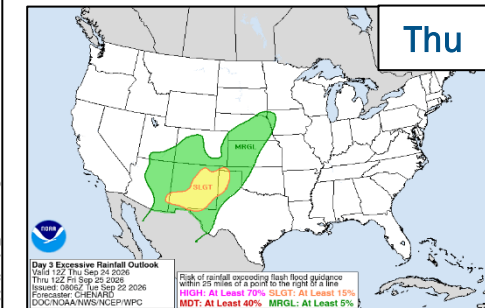
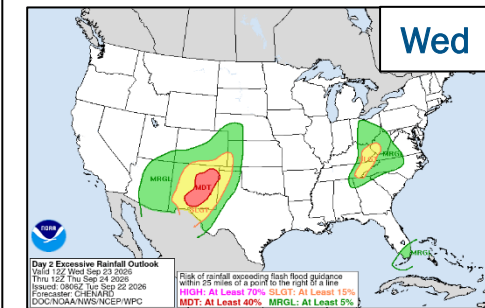
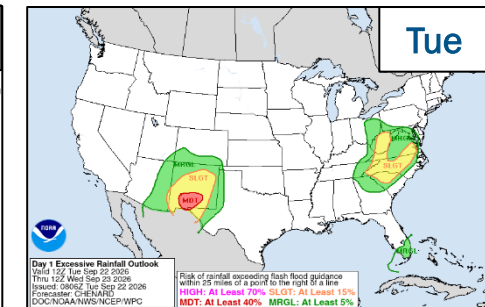
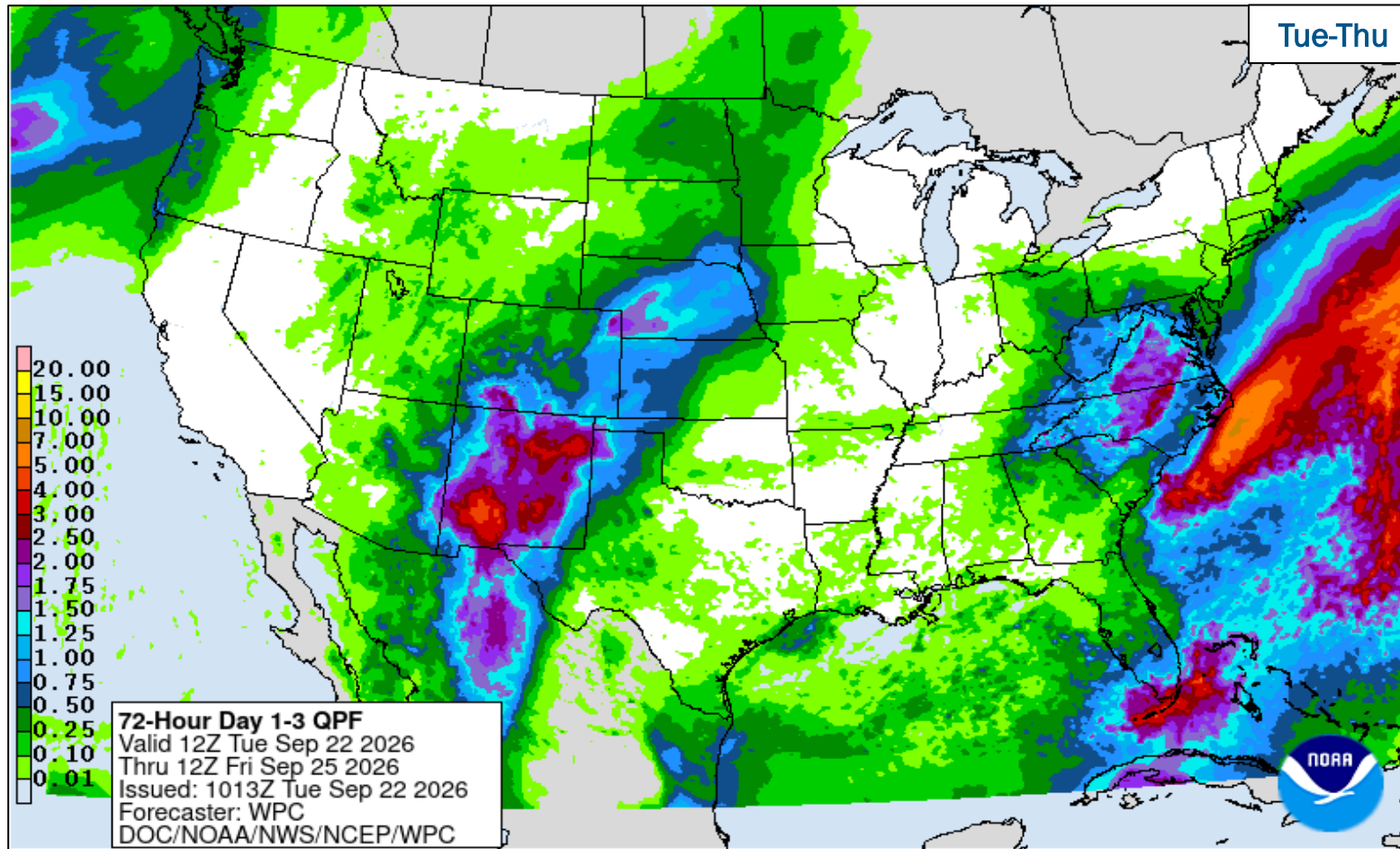
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National Weather Forecast



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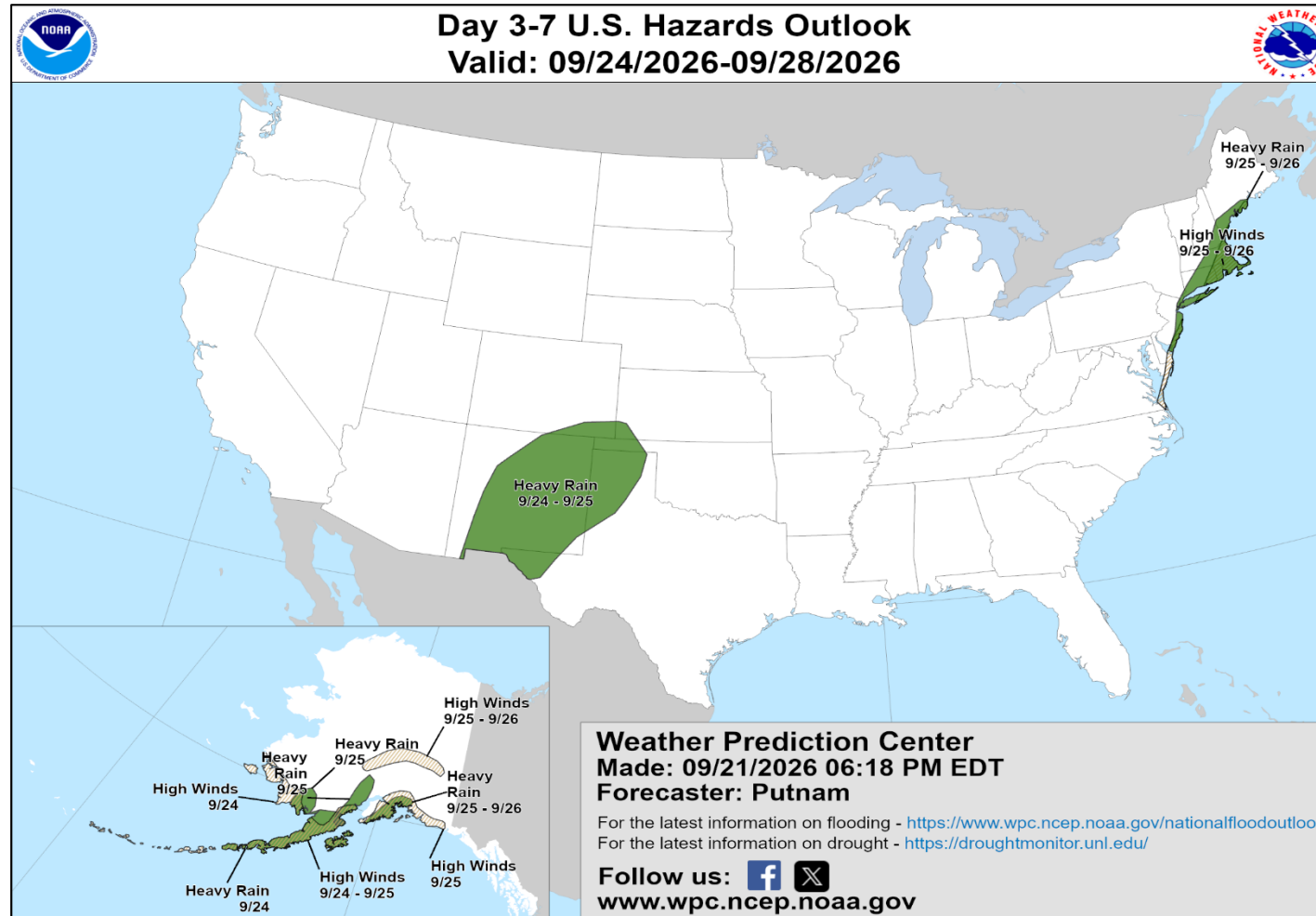
Precipitation & Excessive Rainfall



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Hazards Outlook – Sep 24-28



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National Fire Activity – September 22, 2026

INITIAL ATTACK ACTIVITY (24-hour period)	Light (46 fires)
New Large Fires	3
Large Fires Contained	1
Uncontained Large Fires	33
Year-to-Date Acres Burned	8,542,800
Total Responders	10,289
Type 1 IMTs Deployed	0
Complex IMTs Deployed	7
FMAGS	Total
2026 (FYTD)	63
2025	75
3 Year Average	53

Preparedness Levels:	
PL 1	Minimal fire activity; many resources available
PL 2	Large wildland fires burning throughout country; resources mobilized from other areas
PL 3	Wildfire activity ongoing throughout 25% of country; National Interagency Coordination Center (NICC) sets priorities, allocates resources, and mobilizes assets at national level
PL 4	High levels of fire activity and areas are competing for firefighting resources; 60% of the nation's wildland firefighting resources committed
PL 5	Extremely high levels of fire activity; 80% of nation's firefighting resources committed



Wildfire Summary

Fire Name (County, ST)	FMAG #	Acres Burned	Percent Contained	Evacuations	Structures (Homes / Other)			Fatalities / Injuries
					Threatened	Damaged	Destroyed	
Sand Creek (Beaverhead, MT)	5671-FM-MT	35,520	71%	LIFTED	H: 42	H: 0	H: 0	0 / 8
					O: 0	O: 0	O: 4	

Structures: H = Homes and Mixed Commercial/Residential / O = Non-residential Commercial/Other Minor Structures)



FEMA Common Operating Picture

National Watch Center

Incident Workforce

18,872
Assigned a Disaster Title

5,931 / 31%
Deployed

6,426 / 34%
Available to Deploy for 30 Days

6,515 / 35%
Remaining

Surge Capacity Force
7,697 / 0 / 769
Rostered / Deployed /
Est. Available to Deploy for 30 Days

Tuesday
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National Readiness

National Watch Center

NRCC

N-IMAT Red

N-IMAT White

N-IMAT Blue

N-IMAT Gold

N-IMAT HS

National Notes

National Watch Center:
• Staffing

NRCC:
• Rostered

National IMATs:
• N-IMAT Red: Reconstituting 9/25
• N-IMAT White: Staffing
• N-IMAT Blue: Staffing
• N-IMAT HS: UNGA

REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

	JFO	DR	EM	JRO
R1	0	1	0	0
R2	0	0	0	2
R3	0	2	0	0
R4	3	10	0	1
R5	0	3	0	0
R6	4	7	3	3
R7	0	9	0	0
R8	0	9	0	0
R9	0	6	6	0
R10	4	7	1	0



CNMI
DR-4910-MP &
EM-3647-MP
• R9 IMAT-2

Guam
DR-4921-GU &
EM-3648-GU
• ISB Delta

Hawaii
Floodings
Impacts Poss.



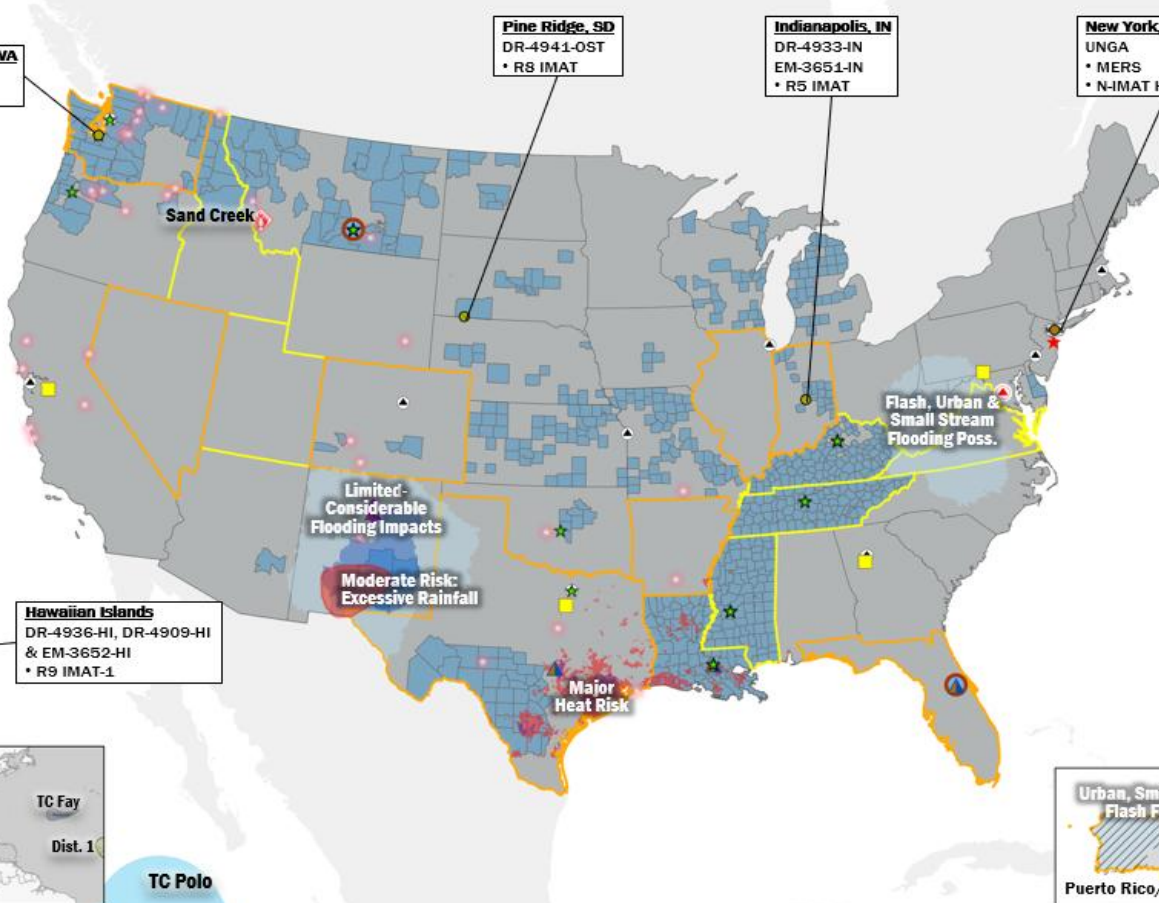
Hawaiian Islands
DR-4936-HI, DR-4909-HI
& EM-3652-HI
• R9 IMAT-1

Camp Murray, WA
EM-3650-WA
• R10 IMAT

Pine Ridge, SD
DR-4941-OST
• R8 IMAT

Indianapolis, IN
DR-4933-IN
EM-3651-IN
• R5 IMAT

New York, NY
UNGA
• MERS
• N-IMAT HS



Regional Readiness

Watch RRCC IMAT

Region 1

Region 2

Region 3

Region 4

Region 5

Region 6

Region 7

Region 8

Region 9

Region 10

Regional Notes

Watches/RRCCs:
• R2 Watch: Equipment
• R5 Watch: Staffing
• R2 RRCC: UNGA
• R10 RRCC: Staffing

State EOCs:
• FL/MS/TN: Previous Incidents
• AK/AR/CO/ID/NV/TX/UT/WA: Wildfires
• IL/KY: Severe Weather
• MP: TC Bavi/Saudel
• PR/VA: Drought
• IN: 4933-DR-IN/3651-EM-IN
• HI: TC Lowell

IMATs:
• R1: Staffing
• R3: Staffing
• R4-1/2: Staffing
• R5: 3651-EM-IN
• R7: Staffing
• R8: 4941-DR-OST
• R9-1: 3652-EM-HI/4909-DR-HI/4936-DR-HI
• R9-2: 4910-DR-MP
• R10: 3650-EM-WA

Legend

- Fully Mission Capable
- Partially Mission Capable
- Requires Augmentation
- Deployed/Activated

Commodities & Equipment

	CONUS	Caribbean	Hawaii	Guam
Water				
Meals				
Generators				

SMT

Operational	11/11
Requires Augmentation	3/11
Deployed	0/11

MERS Det.

30/36 Operational	
Maynard	4/6
Frederick	6/6
Thomasville	6/6
Denton	6/6
Denver	4/6
Bothell	4/6

US&R

Task Forces	
Assigned	28
Non-FEMA Deployed	0
FEMA-Deployed	0
Not Mission Capable	0
Available	28
FEMA Support Staff	11/21

FCO

Assigned	38
Not Mission Capable	1
Deployed	29 (29 FCOR)
Available	8

Joint Preliminary Damage Assessments

Region	State / Location	Event	IA	Number of Counties		Start – End
			PA	Requested	Complete	
R10	AK	Mukluk Fire Aug 21-25	IA	1	0	9/21 – TBD
			PA	1	0	9/21 – TBD



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Declaration Requests in Process – 16

State / Tribe / Territory – Incident Description	Type	IA	PA	HM	Requested
NH – Severe Storm and Flash Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Jul 8
IN – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Aug 6
GU – Super Typhoon Bavi	DR	X	X	X	Aug 11
MN – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Aug 20
UT – Cottonwood Fire, Flooding, and Mudslides	DR		X	X	Aug 22
WI – Severe Storms and Tornado	DR	X	X	X	Aug 26
WV – Severe Storm, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides – Appeal	DR	X		X	Aug 31
NE – Severe Storm, Straight-line Winds, and Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Aug 31
OH – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, Flooding, and Landslides	DR	X		X	Sep 2
OK – Severe Storms and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 2
TN – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lala	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lowell	DR	X	X	X	Sep 9
WV – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Sep 12
IL – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Sep 15
KS – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 15



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Helping people before, during, and after disasters.



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